# Phase 1 & 2 Report: Profile Verification and Global Scholarship Discovery

## Fully Funded Master's Scholarship Project, 2027 Intake

Prepared for: Nebyu Dejenie Tilahun

Version 1.0, 5 November 2026

## Table of Contents

## How to read this report

- **Research date:** 5 November 2026. Every deadline below was checked on this date. Deadlines move, so check each one again on the official page before you submit.
- **Verification labels:**
  - **OFFICIAL** means confirmed from a government, university or scholarship-body source (domain shown).
  - **SECONDARY** means it comes from aggregator or news sites and has not yet been confirmed officially.
  - **UNVERIFIED** means there is no reliable source yet. Do not rely on it.
- **Network limitation:** this research session could not open several official sites directly (si.se, chevening.org, stipendiumhungaricum.hu). Facts from those sites came from search results restricted to their official domains. Each fact is labelled OFFICIAL only where the official page itself was the source.
- **Matching score:** a weighted strategic score from 0 to 100 (see Section C). It is **not** a statistical probability of admission.
- **Sources:** full URLs are in Section I and in the tracker's *Research Sources* sheet.

---

## A. Executive summary

### Applicant profile (verified from your documents in Google Drive)

| Item | What the documents show | Status |
|---|---|---|
| Name on academic record | NEBYU DEJENIE TILAHUN | Must match passport. **Confirm passport spelling** |
| Degree | BSc Computer Science, Faculty of Technology, Debre Tabor University (Ethiopia) | Verified (temporary graduation certificate and transcript) |

| Item | What the documents show | Status |
|---|---|---|
| Award date | 14 July 2022 (Gregorian; transcript generated 15 July 2022) | Verified |
| Study mode | “Admission Classification: Extension”, 5 study years (AcYear 2017/18 to 2021/22) | Verified. Explain this where relevant |
| Medium of instruction | English (stated on transcript) | Verified. Useful for English waivers |
| Cumulative GPA | **2.62 / 4.00** on the transcript (627.75 grade points / 240 credits = 2.6156) | **Conflicts with the 2.67 you reported. See B1** |
| Grading scale | 4.00 scale: A/A+ = 4, A− = 3.75, B+ = 3.5, B = 3, B− = 2.75, C+ = 2.5, C = 2, C− = 1.75, D = 1, F/Fx = 0 | Verified |
| Current role (latest CV) | DevOps Engineer, SantimPay Financial Solution S.C., 18/08/2022 to present | Dates and title **conflict across your CVs. See A3** |
| Other roles listed | Kifiya Financial Technology (IT Operations Engineer); Infonans Solutions (Network Engineer); Plan International Ethiopia and Yandex (older CV only) | **Conflicts. See A3** |
| Technical profile | Linux, Bash/Python, Ansible, Jenkins/Azure DevOps, Docker, Kubernetes ops, Prometheus/Grafana/Splunk /ELK, IAM/MFA, WAF/WAAP, PAM/DAM, VMware ESXi, Azure/AWS | From CV. Needs employer confirmation |
| English | No test score on file. Self-assessed (Europass): C1 listening/reading/writing, **B1 speaking** | Test needed for most targets |
| Age | Within the ≤35 limit (Mastercard Foundation) and the <40 limit (GKS) for 2027 | Verified from CV |

## Overall competitiveness (honest assessment)

**Moderate for practice-oriented, experience-valuing scholarships. Low for grade-driven, elite awards.**

Your profile has two sides:

- **Academic side (weak):** a 2.62 CGPA is below the "upper second" or "top third" level that most elite and government merit scholarships use. The transcript also shows failed first attempts in two mathematics courses.
- **Professional side (genuinely strong):** about 4 years of post-degree work in fintech DevOps, cloud and IT operations, with security tooling, in a field that matches every programme you want. This is exactly what scholarships for working professionals reward, such as Sweden's SI Scholarship for Global Professionals, CMU-Africa and Mastercard Foundation, and Chevening and Fulbright in future cycles.

The strategy is to **lead with professional impact and an upward academic trend**, and to target awards whose eligibility rules you clearly meet.

## Most important strengths

1. **Directly relevant work experience** (about 4 years from August 2022 if SantimPay is continuous). It clears every minimum found:
   - SI: 3,000 hours
   - Chevening: 2,800 hours
   - DAAD EPOS: 2 years
2. **Strong upward academic trend.** Final-year semester averages were **3.05 and 3.35**. Over roughly the final 100 credits the average is **about 3.08** (my arithmetic from the transcript's cumulative totals; unofficial). Strong grades include:
   - Final Project I and II: A−
   - Compiler Design: A−
   - Complexity Theory: A−
   - Advanced Programming: A−
   - Selected Topics: A
3. **The Ethiopian bachelor's degree meets Sweden's English requirement.** Sweden does not need IELTS (OFFICIAL: universityadmissions.se).
4. **Current, in-demand skills** (Kubernetes, CI/CD, observability, IAM, security controls). These fit cloud, DevOps and cybersecurity master's programmes.
5. **Development-impact story:** digital payments and fintech infrastructure in Ethiopia, which links directly to financial inclusion.

## Most important weaknesses and risks

1. **CGPA 2.62.** It is also **0.02 below the Korean GKS cut-off of 2.64**. If 2.67 is official, it passes. This single difference changes eligibility.
2. **Inconsistent CV versions (critical).** Different titles, dates and employers appear across your CVs, and identical bullet points are attributed to two different employers.

Committees and visa officers compare documents, so this must be fixed **before any application**.

3. **No English test score yet.** Most targets outside Sweden need one, and the spoken English self-rating is B1.
4. **Mathematics record.** Probability & Statistics and Discrete Mathematics were failed on first attempt and later passed (C range / D). This is a risk for AI, data science and machine learning programmes, so cloud, security and software engineering programmes are the better fit.
5. **The existing recommendation letter overstates performance.** It calls you "high-performing" in courses graded C+ and C, and contains a template error. It needs replacing.
6. **Timing.** Several 2027 cycles (Chevening, Mastercard Foundation at UBC, McGill and Edinburgh, Fulbright 2027–28, Manchester) **closed before today**.

## A3. Document discrepancies you must resolve (from your own files)

| # | Field | Europass CV (Aug 2026) | Older resume(s) | Transcript / certificate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | CGPA | not stated | not stated | **2.62** (you reported 2.67) |
| 2 | Study period | 14/07/2018 to 14/07/2022 | 09/2018 to 07/2022 | Year 1 = AcYear **2017/2018**; awarded 14 Jul 2022 |
| 3 | SantimPay | **DevOps Engineer**, 18/08/2022 to current | **Technical POS Manager**, 10/2022 to present; summary says "IT Operations Specialist" | n/a |
| 4 | Kifiya | IT Operations Engineer (Hybrid), **03/09/2022 to 15/09/2025** | IT Operations Specialist, **02/2023 to 02/2025**; another resume says Kifiya is your **current** role | n/a |
| 5 | Overlap | SantimPay and Kifiya run **concurrently for 3 years** | same | Explain (part-time, contract, outsourced?) |
| 6 | Plan International | **absent** | "Cloud Infrastructure | n/a |

| # | Field | Europass CV (Aug 2026) | Older resume(s) | Transcript / certificate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Ethiopia | | and Monitoring Engineer, Remote, 08/2022 to 10/2023". Its bullet points are **identical** to the SantimPay DevOps bullets in the Europass CV | |
| 7 | Yandex (Odoo Developer, 06/2025) | absent | present | n/a |
| 8 | Infonans | 19/07/2022 to 31/08/2022 | 06/2022 to 09/2022 | n/a |
| 9 | Total experience | about 4 yrs 3 mo (Aug 2022 to Nov 2026) if continuous | "over two years" (older) | You reported **3 yrs 6 mo** |
| 10 | Name spelling | Nebyu Dejenie | Nebiyu Dejenie (LinkedIn / website) | NEBYU DEJENIE TILAHUN |
| 11 | Unfinished text | "Co-Trainer **Write here the descriptio**…" (template text left in CV) | n/a | n/a |
| 12 | Certifications | "Certified Kubernetes Administrator, issued July 2022, expires July 2025" | not listed | Needs a verification ID. Mark as expired |

**Rule going forward:** each employer, title and date must appear **identically** in every application, and must be supported by an employer experience letter. I will build one *verified employment history* (00_MASTER_PROFILE) once you confirm the facts. I will not choose between conflicting versions for you.

## B. GPA and academic assessment

### B1. GPA analysis

- **Transcript figure:** final cumulative average **2.62 / 4.00**. The cumulative totals (627.75 points / 240 credits) independently give 2.6156. Two failed courses were later replaced: 245 credits were attempted and 240 counted.
- **You reported 2.67.** I found no document showing 2.67.
  - If your **printed diploma** or a later official record shows 2.67, upload it and the official document will govern.
  - Otherwise, applications must use **2.62**. Universities verify against the transcript.
- **Trajectory (from transcript semester averages):**
  - Early years mostly 2.2–2.7
  - Year 4, semester 1: 1.25 (the failed mathematics attempts)
  - Final year: **3.05 → 3.35**
- **Approximate GPA over the final ~100 credits: about 3.08 / 4.00.** This is *my unofficial calculation* from cumulative totals. The university or an evaluator must confirm it. It matters for universities that assess the **last two years** (for example the University of Manitoba, which uses the most recent two years for non-North-American transcripts; OFFICIAL).
- **Course-level strengths for cloud, security and systems programmes:**
  - Final Project I & II: A–
  - Compiler Design: A–
  - Complexity Theory: A–
  - Advanced Programming: A–
  - Selected Topics in CS: A
  - Intro to AI: B
  - Computer Security: B
  - Intro to Distributed Systems: B–
  - Network & System Administration: B–
  - Internet Programming: B–
- **Course-level weaknesses:**
  - Probability & Statistics: Fx, then F, then passed
  - Discrete Mathematics: Fx, then D
  - Linear Algebra: C–
  - Data Structures & Algorithms: C

### B2. Ethiopian qualification considerations

- **Recognition:** Debre Tabor University is a public Ethiopian university.
  - Sweden requires the programme to be accredited by the **FDRE Education and Training Authority (ETA, formerly HERQA)** at the time of study (OFFICIAL: universityadmissions.se).

  - Germany relies on the **anabin** database / uni-assist evaluation. Debre Tabor's anabin status is **UNVERIFIED** (anabin could not be reached in this session) and must be checked.
- **Extension (part-time) programme:** this is the same BSc degree, but some evaluators ask about it. Keep a registrar letter confirming the degree is identical to the regular programme, in case one is requested.
- **Credits:** 240 Ethiopian credit hours over 5 years. Erasmus Mundus programmes typically ask for a bachelor's of at least 180 ECTS. Ethiopian 4-year BSc degrees are normally treated as equivalent, but **confirm with each consortium**.
- **Authentication:** many programmes and visa offices ask for degree documents authenticated by the Ethiopian Ministry of Education and the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. This is a common requirement; confirm it per programme.
- **Grade conversion:**
  - **Germany:** uses the official KMK "modified Bavarian formula": German grade = 1 + 3 × (Nmax − Nd) / (Nmax − Nmin). The result depends on the minimum passing grade (Nmin) that uni-assist or anabin assigns to Ethiopian degrees, which is **UNVERIFIED**. *Illustration only, not an official conversion:* with Nmin = 1.0 the result would be about 2.4; with Nmin = 2.0 it would be about 3.1. Only uni-assist's evaluation counts.
  - **Korea (GKS):** uses the transcript CGPA directly on its 4.0 scale. The cut-off is 2.64 (OFFICIAL embassy notices, 2026 cycle). No conversion is needed, so 2.62 vs 2.67 is decisive.
  - **Türkiye Burslari:** requires 75% for master's (SECONDARY). Their conversion method for a 4.0 scale is **UNVERIFIED**.

## B3. Academic eligibility risks by scholarship type

| Category | Typical academic rule | Your status |
|---|---|---|
| SI Scholarship for Global Professionals (Sweden) | No national GPA minimum; universities rank on merit | **Eligible**; competitiveness moderate |
| CMU-Africa + Mastercard Foundation | "No cut-offs exist for GPA"; most admits ≥ 3.0 (OFFICIAL) | **Eligible**; below the typical profile, so essays and tests matter |
| Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters | Set per consortium; GPA usually weighted heavily | **Potentially eligible**; competitiveness low to moderate |
| Stipendium Hungaricum | University entrance exam or interview; Szeged scores core-course grades (50/100) | **Potentially eligible**; good feasibility |
| Chinese Government Scholarship | University-specific | **Potentially eligible** (needs university confirmation) |
| Korea GKS-G | CGPA ≥ 2.64/4.0 **or** top 20% of class (OFFICIAL) | **Ineligible at 2.62 / eligible at 2.67.** A class-rank letter is the alternative route |
| DAAD EPOS (Germany) | "Far above average results | **Likely ineligible** unless a |

| Category | Typical academic rule | Your status |
|---|---|---|
| | (upper third)"; degree normally ≤ 6 years old (OFFICIAL: DAAD) | rank letter shows upper third |
| Chevening (UK) | Needs an unconditional offer from a UK university; universities set the grade | Eligible in principle for **2028/29** (2027/28 closed) |
| Canadian thesis MSc (e.g. Manitoba) | 3.0/4.5 over the last two years (OFFICIAL) | **Eligibility requires university confirmation** (your last-two-years GPA may qualify) |

### B4. Recommended academic strategy

1. **Settle the official CGPA** (2.62 vs 2.67) and request a **class-rank or percentile letter** from the registrar. It opens GKS (top 20%) and possibly EPOS (upper third) only if the rank genuinely supports it.
2. **Request a registrar-certified "last two years" GPA statement** if the university will issue one.
3. **Address the GPA once, briefly and factually** (in an optional statement where the application allows one). Mention the extension study mode alongside full-time work from 2022, the mathematics repeats, and the clear upward trend. No excuses or invented hardship.
4. **Offset with verifiable evidence:**
   - A refreshed, **in-date cloud or Kubernetes certification** with a verification ID (for example re-certifying CKA, or AWS/Azure associate level)
   - A public **GitHub portfolio** (CI/CD pipelines, Ansible roles, Kubernetes manifests, monitoring dashboards), with any employer-confidential material removed
5. **Prefer systems, cloud, security and software-engineering programmes** over math-heavy AI/ML programmes. Your transcript is strongest there.

## C. Top scholarship opportunities (ranked)

**Scoring framework (transparent):**

- Academic eligibility: 25%
- Funding coverage: 25%
- Programme relevance: 15%
- Professional experience alignment: 15%
- Admission flexibility: 10%
- Application feasibility (timeline and requirements): 10%

Each criterion is scored 0–10 from the evidence; the weighted total is out of 100. Full scoring is in the tracker (*Eligibility Assessment* sheet).

## C1. PRIMARY SHORTLIST: fully funded and achievable for 2027

| Rank | Opportunity | Funding | GPA rule | Your eligibility | Key 2027 dates | Status | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **CMU-Africa (Kigali, Rwanda): MS Information Technology + Mastercard Foundation Scholars Program** | **FULLY FUNDED.** Tuition and fees, health insurance, travel, basic living, project support (OFFICIAL / SECONDARY) | No GPA cut-off (OFFICIAL) | Eligible (African national, BSc) | **Early: 15 Dec 2026** (CMU covers Duolingo English Test fee). **Final: 15 Jan 2027** (OFFICIAL page dates; year inferred) | **OPEN NOW** | **88.5** |

| Rank | Opportunity | Funding | GPA rule | Your eligibility | Key 2027 dates | Status | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | **Sweden: SI Scholarship for Global Professionals** (eligible MSc in software engineering, cybersecurity or computer systems) | **FULLY FUNDED.** Tuition paid directly to the university, monthly living allowance, SEK 15,000 travel grant (OFFICIAL). Insurance: SI says not included; university cover to be confirmed | No national minimum | **Eligible:** Ethiopia is on the 34-country list; ≥ 3,000 h work by Feb 2027; leadership evidence required (OFFICIAL) | University application **15 Jan 2027**; SI application **8–24 Feb 2027**; results 22 Apr 2027; eligible programme list published **13 Nov 2026** (OFFICIAL / SECONDARY) | **OPEN NOW** (university stage) | **86.0** |
| 3 | **Erasmus Mundus CYBERSURE: Cybersecurity and Assurance** (NTNU and Nordic partners) | **FULLY FUNDED** if selected for the EM scholarship (€1,400/month plus participation costs; confirm on programme site) | Not published; CS bachelor's required (OFFICIAL: NTNU) | Potentially eligible | **16 Nov 2026 to 5 Jan 2027** (Aalto: OFFICIAL; another Aalto page says 4 Jan, so use **4 Jan**) | **OPENING SOON** | **77.5** |

| Rank | Opportunity | Funding | GPA rule | Your eligibility | Key 2027 dates | Status | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | **Erasmus Mundus SE4GD: Software Engineers for Green Deal** (LUT, Univ. L'Aquila, VU Amsterdam) | **FULLY FUNDED** if EM scholarship | **UNVERIFIED** | Potentially eligible | Expected Jan–Feb 2027 (**UNVERIFIED**) | **UPCOMING** | **77.5** |
| 5 | **China: Chinese Government Scholarship (CSC)**, Type A via Ethiopian MoE or Type B via a university | **FULLY FUNDED** (tuition, accommodation, stipend, insurance; amounts to verify) | University-specific | Potentially eligible | 2027/28 cycle open (Indonesian embassy notice, deadline 14 Feb 2027: OFFICIAL for Indonesia only). **Ethiopia date UNVERIFIED** | **OPEN / VERIFY** | **74.0** |
| 6 | **Erasmus Mundus CYBERUS: Cybersecurity** (UBS France, ULB, Univ. Luxembo | FULLY FUNDED if EM scholarship | UNVERIFIED | Potentially eligible | **2027 scholarship intake not confirmed** | **ELIGIBILITY UNCERTAIN** | **73.5** |

| Rank | Opportunity | Funding | GPA rule | Your eligibility | Key 2027 dates | Status | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | urg) | | | | | | |
| 7 | **Erasmus Mundus DEAI: Data Engineering & AI** (ULB, UPC and partners) | FULLY FUNDED (€1,400/ month for up to 24 months, tuition, insurance; SECONDARY) | Not published | Potentially eligible (maths-heavy: risk) | **Scholarship deadline 11 Jan 2027, 12:00 GMT** (SECONDARY, multiple agree) | **OPEN NOW** | **72.0** |
| 8 | **Korea: GKS Graduate (GKS-G) 2027**, Embassy track (Addis Ababa) or University track | **FULLY FUNDED** (airfare, tuition, monthly allowance, Korean-language year; amounts per 2027 guideline) | **CGPA ≥ 2.64/4.0 or top 20%** (OFFICIAL, 2026 guideline) | **Depends on 2.62 vs 2.67 or class rank** | 2027 guideline not yet published; 2026 embassy deadlines were about Feb–Mar | **UPCOMING** | **66.0** |

**Erasmus Mundus rule:** you may apply to a **maximum of 3** Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters per cycle (SECONDARY; confirm in each call).

**Recommended picks:**

- **CYBERSURE** and **SE4GD**
- Third choice: **CYBERUS** if its 2027 scholarship call opens; otherwise **DEAI**

## C2. Strong backups (not fully funded by this report's definition)

| Opportunity | Funding class | Why it is still worth it | Dates |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hungary: Stipendium Hungaricum**, MSc Computer Science (e.g. Univ. of Szeged, ELTE, Univ. of | **NEARLY FULLY FUNDED.** Tuition-free; **HUF 43,700/month** stipend; free dorm place **or** HUF | Ethiopia is a sending partner (OFFICIAL); selection by entrance test or interview; high feasibility | 2026/27 ran 14 Nov 2025 to 15 Jan 2026 (OFFICIAL). 2027/28 expected about mid-Nov 2026 to mid-Jan 2027 (**UNVERIFIED**). |

| Opportunity | Funding class | Why it is still worth it | Dates |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pannonia) | 40,000/month housing; medical insurance (OFFICIAL, 2026/27 call). The call itself calls the stipend a *partial* contribution | | Ethiopian MoE nomination also required |
| **Canada: University of Manitoba MSc Computer Science (thesis)** | **NEARLY / PARTIALLY FUNDED.** Department minimum **CAD 20,000/yr for 2 years** for admitted MSc students (OFFICIAL, dept page) | Uses the **last two years** GPA for international transcripts, minimum 3.0/4.5 (OFFICIAL). A supervisor match is needed | Fall 2027 deadline: dept page shows 15 Jan / 1 Dec (international row unclear). **Confirm by email** |
| **Italy: regional DSU grants** (e.g. ESU Padova, EDISU Piemonte) + public university MSc | **NEARLY FULLY FUNDED** (need-based). About €8,000+/yr plus fee exemption (SECONDARY) | Need-based, not GPA-driven, at entry | 2027/28 calls about mid-2027 (**UNVERIFIED**) |
| **Türkiye Burslari** | FULLY FUNDED | Eligibility depends on how 2.62/4.0 converts against the 75% minimum (**UNVERIFIED**) | About 10 Jan to 20 Feb 2027 (SECONDARY) |
| **Germany: tuition-free public university MSc** (e.g. TH Köln *Communication Systems and Networks*) | **SELF-FUNDED.** Blocked account **€11,904/yr (€992/month)** since Jan 2025 (OFFICIAL: DAAD; 2026 update **UNVERIFIED**) | Low tuition; strong IT market | Programme-specific |

## C3. Next-cycle targets (2028 intake). Prepare now.

| Opportunity | Why not 2027 | Fit |
|---|---|---|
| **Chevening (UK)** | 2027/28 closed **6 Oct 2026, 11:00 UTC** (OFFICIAL) | **Very strong fit.** You meet 2,800 h and the 2-year-since-degree rule, Ethiopia is eligible, and leadership is |

| Opportunity | Why not 2027 | Fit |
|---|---|---|
| | | weighted. Opens about Aug 2027 |
| **Fulbright Foreign Student Program (USA)** | 2027–28 cycle deadline reported as 2 May 2026 (SECONDARY) | Good fit for professionals; J-1 two-year home-residency rule applies |
| **Mastercard Foundation at UBC / McGill** | UBC expression of interest closed **6 Sep 2026** (OFFICIAL); McGill closed 21 Aug 2026 (SECONDARY) | Eligible profile (African citizen-resident, ≤35, no master's) |
| **Univ. of Manchester Equity & Merit** | Window 1–31 Aug 2026 (SECONDARY; one official-domain snippet showed 6 Dec 2026, so **verify**) | Ethiopia eligible; course list usually development-focused |

## C4. Priority C: low potential or ineligible (with reasons)

| Opportunity | Reason |
|---|---|
| DAAD EPOS (Germany) | Requires "far above average (upper third)" results (OFFICIAL). No computer science or IT course confirmed on the 2027/28 list (OFFICIAL list snippets show HfT Stuttgart *Photogrammetry & Geoinformatics* as the nearest) |
| Mastercard Foundation at Univ. of Edinburgh | 2027/28 required attendance at an information session (15–24 Sep 2026) and covers no computer science programme (OFFICIAL) |
| Mastercard Foundation at Univ. of Toronto | 2026/27 restricted to graduates of Africa Health Collaborative partner institutions (OFFICIAL PDF). Debre Tabor University's partner status is unverified and unlikely |
| Commonwealth Shared / Commonwealth Master's | Ethiopia is not a Commonwealth country |
| Knight-Hennessy, Oxford/Cambridge full awards | Extremely grade-selective; 2.62 is not competitive. 2027 cycles not re-verified this session |
| Heinrich Böll / Konrad Adenauer (Germany) | Require above-average grades and existing German admission or enrolment. **Criteria not re-verified this session** |

## C5. Research queue (Phase 2b, not yet verified, so not ranked)

- Australia Awards Africa
- AIMS African Master's in Machine Intelligence (2027 dates not found; fully funded)

- Japan MEXT (GPA formula likely unfavourable; 2027 embassy round likely closed)
- KAUST
- Finland university scholarships
- Netherlands
- Belgium VLIR-UOS
- Italian MAECI scholarships
- New Zealand Manaaki
- Singapore

---

## D. Country comparison

| Country | Fully funded routes that fit you | 2027 outlook | Verdict |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Germany** | EPOS (grade bar too high); foundations (grade bar too high) | Low cost, but **self-funded** (≥ €11,904/yr blocked account) | **Backup only** unless a rank letter shows upper-third standing |
| **USA** | Fulbright (closed for 2027); assistantships rare at master's level | Weak for 2027. Ethiopia is **not** on the list of countries restricted by Proclamation 10998 (effective 1 Jan 2026), per the White House text as summarised (OFFICIAL); re-check before any application | **2028 via Fulbright** |
| **Canada** | Mastercard Foundation (closed for 2027); funded thesis MSc (Manitoba and others) | Master's students at public universities **no longer need a provincial attestation letter** from 1 Jan 2026 (OFFICIAL: IRCC). Proof of funds was **CAD 22,895** from 1 Sep 2025 (OFFICIAL); check the 2026 update | **Possible via a funded thesis MSc**; full funding uncertain |
| **United Kingdom** | Chevening (closed for 2027); Manchester (closed) | Student visa maintenance £1,136/month outside | **2028 via Chevening** |

| Country | Fully funded routes that fit you | 2027 outlook | Verdict |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | London (one GOV.UK page shows £1,171: **conflict, verify**) | |
| **Sweden** | **SI Scholarship for Global Professionals** | **Best Western option for 2027.** No IELTS needed for Ethiopian bachelor's holders | **Priority A** |
| **EU multi-country (Erasmus Mundus)** | CYBERSURE, SE4GD, CYBERUS, DEAI | Deadlines Dec 2026 to Feb 2027 | **Priority A/B** (competitive) |
| **Rwanda (US degree)** | **CMU-Africa + Mastercard Foundation** | Deadlines 15 Dec 2026 / 15 Jan 2027 | **Priority A: highest fit** |
| **Hungary** | Stipendium Hungaricum | Expected Nov 2026 to Jan 2027 | **High-feasibility backup** |
| **China / Korea / Türkiye** | CSC / GKS / Türkiye Burslari | Jan–Mar 2027 | **B** (Korea depends on CGPA) |

## E. 2027 application strategy

### E1. Urgent deadlines (next 75 days)

| Date | Action |
|---|---|
| **This week (by 12 Nov 2026)** | Resolve CV discrepancies; confirm CGPA; request registrar documents (rank letter, authenticated transcript, permanent diploma); ask 3 recommenders; book the Duolingo English Test (DET) |
| **13 Nov 2026** | SI publishes its 2027/28 eligible programme list. Choose up to 4 Swedish programmes (universityadmissions.se allows ranked choices) |
| **16 Nov 2026** | CYBERSURE application opens; Stipendium Hungaricum call expected around now (**UNVERIFIED**) |
| **by 1 Dec 2026** | Take the DET (CMU-Africa recommends ≥ 120) and CMU-Africa competency tests |
| **15 Dec 2026** | **CMU-Africa early deadline** (DET fee covered) |
| **4 Jan 2027** | **CYBERSURE deadline** (use the earlier of the |

| Date | Action |
|---|---|
| | two dates Aalto publishes) |
| **11 Jan 2027** | **DEAI scholarship deadline** (if chosen) |
| **15 Jan 2027** | **universityadmissions.se deadline (Sweden)**; **CMU-Africa final deadline**; Stipendium Hungaricum (expected) |
| **Jan–Feb 2027** | SE4GD (TBC); CSC Type B university deadlines; Türkiye Burslari |
| **8–24 Feb 2027** | **SI scholarship application** |
| **Feb–Mar 2027** | GKS-G embassy track (only if CGPA or rank qualifies) |

## E2. Recommended application order

1. **CMU-Africa MSIT** (early deadline; holistic; no fee)
2. **Sweden: SI Scholarship for Global Professionals** (university application, then scholarship application)
3. **CYBERSURE**
4. **SE4GD**
5. **Third Erasmus Mundus programme** (CYBERUS or DEAI)
6. **Stipendium Hungaricum** (backup with high feasibility)
7. **CSC (China)**
8. **GKS** (conditional on CGPA or rank)
9. **University of Manitoba** (contact potential supervisors now)

Then in mid-2027, prepare **Chevening 2028/29** and **Fulbright 2028–29** as parallel insurance.

## E3. Preparation schedule

- **Weeks 1–2:**
  - Master profile and verified employment history
  - Master CV (international format)
  - Master statement of purpose (SOP)
  - Recommender briefing packs
  - Start DET preparation (daily, see the tracker)
- **Weeks 3–4:** CMU-Africa essays (3 × ≤ 300 words, plus optional fourth); submit by 15 Dec
- **Weeks 5–8:** CYBERSURE / Erasmus Mundus motivation letters; Swedish programme applications; Hungary application
- **Weeks 9–12:** SI scholarship-specific CV and motivation (leadership focus); CSC; GKS if eligible

## F. Document checklist

### Already available (found in your Google Drive)

- Temporary Certificate of Graduation and Student Academic Record (transcript), Debre Tabor University. **Generated 15 Jul 2022; it says "official only when signed and sealed".**
- Europass CV (latest, 7 Aug 2026), plus several older resumes (with conflicts: see A3)
- Recommendation letter from [former lecturer, name withheld] (MSc), Lecturer, SITE, DTU, dated 4 Nov 2024. **Not recommended for reuse** (overstates grades, template error, generic addressee)
- Passport folder exists in Drive. **I did not open it** (sensitive). Only the name spelling and expiry date are needed now.

### Still required

- ☐ **Permanent (printed) degree diploma.** The certificate says it was issued "pending the printing" of the diploma.
- ☐ **Official, sealed or authenticated transcript.** Check each programme's format (certified copy, MoE/MoFA authentication, or sealed envelope).
- ☐ **Registrar class-rank / percentile letter** (for GKS and EPOS) and, if possible, a last-two-years GPA statement
- ☐ **Employer experience letters** (letterhead, signed, stamped): title, exact dates, full- or part-time status, main duties. One each from SantimPay, Kifiya and any other employer you will list.
- ☐ **English test:** DET (by early December) and/or IELTS Academic
- ☐ **Passport bio page** (validity must cover the whole study period, ideally beyond 2029)
- ☐ **Three new recommendation letters:** 1–2 academic (ideally final-project supervisor and an A-grade course lecturer) and 1–2 professional (current line manager; Kifiya supervisor)
- ☐ **Certification evidence** with verification IDs (CKA, Azure Fundamentals, Fortinet NSE). Mark expired ones as expired.
- ☐ **Portfolio:** GitHub repositories and personal website (nebiyu.dev.et per older CV), cleaned of employer-confidential data
- ☐ Programme-specific items: medical certificate (Hungary), CSC physical examination form, police clearance (some visas)

### Requires verification

- CGPA 2.67 vs 2.62
- Study start date
- All employment titles and dates
- CKA validity and issue date
- Plan International and Yandex roles
- Debre Tabor University anabin status (Germany)
- ETA accreditation of the programme for your study years (Sweden)

## G. Missing information: essential questions only

1. **CGPA:** does any official document (printed diploma, newer transcript) show **2.67**? If not, should we proceed with **2.62**?
2. **Passport:** the exact name spelling and the **expiry date** only. Please do not send the passport number.
3. **Employment truth table.** For each role, give:
   - employer, exact title, start and end dates (dd/mm/yyyy)
   - full-time or part-time
   - whether you can get an experience letter

   Please specifically explain:
   - the SantimPay and Kifiya overlap
   - the Plan International Ethiopia role (whose bullets duplicate the SantimPay bullets)
   - Yandex
   - which job title at SantimPay is current (DevOps Engineer or Technical POS Manager)
4. **Leadership evidence:** have you led a team, project or rollout? How many people? Any community, volunteer or training work beyond the Dereja co-trainer role?
5. **Class rank:** can the registrar state your rank or percentile in the cohort?
6. **English:** any previous test? Can you sit a Duolingo English Test in the next 3 weeks?
7. **Destinations:** are Rwanda (CMU-Africa), Hungary, China and Korea acceptable? Are you willing to accept **return-home commitments** (Mastercard Foundation, Chevening, Fulbright)?
8. **Recommenders:** names and titles of 2 academic and 2 professional referees who know your work.
9. **Budget:** roughly how much can you spend on tests, application fees and courier/authentication over the next 3 months?

## H. Next actions

### Upload to Google Drive (or tell me where they are)

1. Printed degree diploma (if issued) and any newer official transcript
2. Employer experience letters (or tell me which ones you can request)
3. Certification certificates and IDs
4. A redacted passport bio page (name and expiry visible; number masked). **Only when we reach the application stage.**

## What I will prepare next (Phase 3–5)

1. **Verified master applicant profile and employment history** (after your answers)
2. **International master CV** (2-page academic/professional) in DOCX and PDF
3. **Master statement of purpose**, then the **CMU-Africa essay set** (3 × ≤ 300 words) as the first customised package (earliest deadline)
4. **Recommender briefing packs** (facts recommenders may use, so letters stay accurate)
5. **Duolingo English Test / IELTS 4-week plan** (already outlined in the tracker)
6. After 13 Nov: **Swedish programme selection** from the official SI list, plus SI-specific documents

## Next execution phase

**Phase 3, Academic Eligibility Confirmation**, starts as soon as you answer Section G, in parallel with **Phase 5** document drafting for CMU-Africa.

## Current risks

1. CV inconsistency (credibility)
2. The CGPA cut-off issue (GKS)
3. No English score yet
4. A compressed timeline (5 key deadlines in 10 weeks)
5. Several official sites must be re-checked directly before submission (network limits in this session)

---

# I. Sources (accessed 5 November 2026)

| Claim | Source | Status |
|---|---|---|
| Chevening Ethiopia: deadline 6 Oct 2026 11:00 UTC; 2,800 h work; 2-year return | https://www.chevening.org/scholarship/ethiopia/ ; https://www.chevening.org/scholarships/who-can-apply/ | OFFICIAL (via domain-restricted search) |
| SI SGP: 34 countries incl. Ethiopia; 3,000 h; leadership; SEK 15,000 travel grant; tuition paid to university | https://si.se/en/apply/scholarships/swedish-institute-scholarships-for-global-professionals/ ; https://si.se/en/apply/faq-scholarships-on-masters-level/ | OFFICIAL (via domain-restricted search) |
| SI 2027 timeline 8–24 Feb 2027; list 13 Nov | https://si.se/en/fully-funded-scholarships-for-masters-studies-in-sweden/ ; https://si.se/en/apply/schol | OFFICIAL / SECONDARY |

| Claim | Source | Status |
|---|---|---|
| | arships/pioneeringwomeninstem/ | |
| Ethiopian bachelor's meets English 6; ETA accreditation | https://www.universityadmissions.se/en/apply-to-masters/provide-application-documents-masters/country-instructions/ethiopia/ | OFFICIAL |
| CMU-Africa: no GPA cut-off; IELTS 6.5 / TOEFL 81 / DET 120; no fee; 1 Oct / 15 Dec / 15 Jan | https://www.africa.engineering.cmu.edu/admissions/faq.html ; https://www.africa.engineering.cmu.edu/admissions/index.html ; https://www.africa.engineering.cmu.edu/impact/mastercard-foundation-scholars.html | OFFICIAL |
| CYBERSURE window 16 Nov 2026 to 5 Jan 2027 (4 Jan on another Aalto page) | https://www.aalto.fi/en/study-options/cybersecurity-and-assurance-cybersure-erasmus-mundus-master-of-science-technology ; https://www.ntnu.edu/studies/mscybsure | OFFICIAL |
| DEAI scholarship deadline 11 Jan 2027 | https://gizpulse.com/opportunities/erasmus-mundus-deai-scholarship-2027 ; https://erasmusscholarship.com/erasmus-mundus-deai-scholarship/ ; official: https://deai.ulb.be/ | SECONDARY |
| Erasmus Mundus timing and catalogue | https://erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu/opportunities/individuals/students/erasmus-mundus-joint-masters | OFFICIAL |
| GKS-G CGPA 2.64/4.0 or top 20% | https://www.mofa.go.kr/sg-en/brd/m_2435/view.do?seq=761574 ; https://et.mofa.go.kr/et-en/brd/m_23675/view.do? | OFFICIAL (2026 cycle) |

| Claim | Source | Status |
|---|---|---|
| | seq=758548 | |
| Stipendium Hungaricum: Ethiopia a partner; HUF 43,700; housing; 2026/27 deadline | https://stipendiumhungaricum.hu/partners/ ; https://stipendiumhungaricum.hu/wp-content/uploads/2025/10/BA_MA_OTM_Call_for_Applications_2026_27.pdf | OFFICIAL |
| Szeged / ELTE MSc CS admission criteria | https://apply.stipendiumhungaricum.hu/courses/course/1530-msc-computer-science ; https://apply.stipendiumhungaricum.hu/courses/course/441-msc-computer-science-budapest | OFFICIAL |
| CSC 2027/28 cycle open (Indonesia, 14 Feb 2027) | https://id.china-embassy.gov.cn/eng/sgdt/202610/t20261027_12047753.htm | OFFICIAL (Indonesia only) |
| DAAD EPOS: upper third; 2 years' experience; degree ≤ 6 years | https://www2.daad.de/deutschland/stipendium/datenbank/en/21148-scholarship-database/?detail=50076777 ; https://static.daad.de/media/daad_de/pdfs_nicht_barrierefrei/in-deutschland-studieren-forschen-lehren/epos-course_overview__2027_28.pdf | OFFICIAL |
| Germany blocked account €11,904/yr | https://www.daad.de/en/studying-in-germany/living-in-germany/finances/ | OFFICIAL |
| Manitoba: 3.0/4.5 last two years; CAD 20,000 minimum MSc funding; IELTS 6.5 | https://umanitoba.ca/graduate-studies/admissions/requirements/international ; https://umanitoba.ca/science/student-experience/financial-aid-awards/computer-science ; https://umanitoba.ca/gradu | OFFICIAL |

| Claim | Source | Status |
|---|---|---|
| | ate-studies/admissions/programs-of-study/computer-science-msc | |
| Canada: PAL exemption for master's from 1 Jan 2026; CAD 22,895 | https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/study-canada/graduate-student.html ; https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/corporate/transparency/transition-binders/deputy-minister-2026/international-student-program.html | OFFICIAL |
| UK Student visa maintenance £1,136 / £1,483 (conflict: £1,171) | https://www.gov.uk/guidance/financial-evidence-for-student-and-child-student-route-applicants ; https://www.gov.uk/student-visa/money | OFFICIAL (conflicting) |
| US Proclamation 10998 country lists | https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2025/12/restricting-and-limiting-the-entry-of-foreign-nationals-to-protect-the-security-of-the-united-states/ ; https://www.nafsa.org/regulatory-information/proclamation-december-16-2025-travel-ban-effective-january-1-2026 | OFFICIAL / professional body |
| Mastercard Foundation UBC expression of interest 6 Sep 2026 | https://mastercardfdn.scholars.ubc.ca/graduate-admissions/graduate-admissions-2/ | OFFICIAL |
| Mastercard Foundation Edinburgh 2027/28 process and programme list | https://edinburgh-global.ed.ac.uk/mastercard-foundation-scholars-program/apply-for-a-scholarship/application-timelines ; https://edinburgh- | OFFICIAL |

| Claim | Source | Status |
|---|---|---|
| | global.ed.ac.uk/mastercard-foundation-scholars-program/apply-for-a-scholarship/frequently-asked-questions | |
| Mastercard Foundation Toronto partner restriction | https://internationalexperience.utoronto.ca/wp-content/uploads/Graduate-MCF-Announcement-2026-27-1.pdf | OFFICIAL |
| Manchester Equity & Merit: Ethiopia eligible; Aug 2026 window | https://www.manchester.ac.uk/study/masters/fees-and-funding/masters-student-funding/equity-merit-scholarships/ ; https://www.afrocareers.com/2026/08/university-of-manchester-equity-and.html | OFFICIAL / SECONDARY (date conflict) |
| Fulbright Ethiopia 2027–28 deadline 2 May 2026 | https://etcareers.com/blog/fully-funded-scholarships-ethiopians-guide | SECONDARY |
| Türkiye Burslari 75%; Jan–Feb 2027 | https://opportunitiesnexus.com/turkiye-scholarships-2027/ | SECONDARY |
| Italy DSU amounts | https://guides.scholarshipunion.com/italy-dsu/ | SECONDARY |
| Modified Bavarian formula | https://www.uni-passau.de/en/apply/apply-with-intl-qualifications/international-grade-converter | OFFICIAL (method) |